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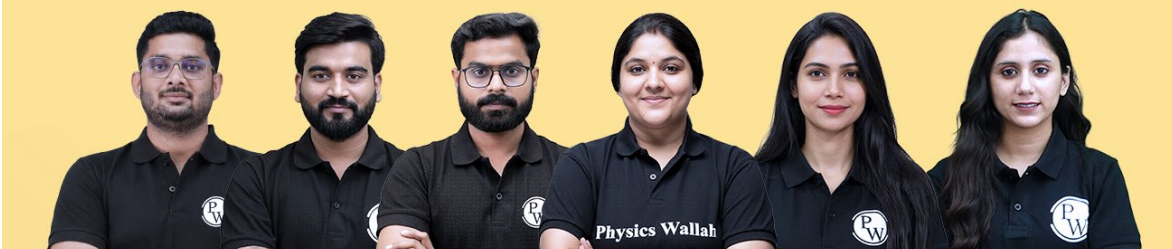


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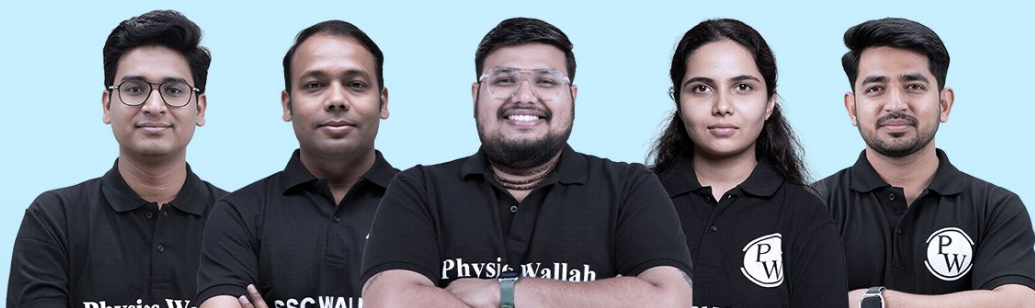
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Banking and Finance

1. Apple Pay Debuts in India Through Strategic Partnership with Axis Bank



- ❖ Apple has officially launched **Apple Pay** in India, marking its entry into the country's digital payments ecosystem after a prolonged global rollout.
- ❖ Axis Bank serves as the primary banking partner at launch, enabling users to add eligible credit cards directly to their Apple Wallet.
- ❖ The initial rollout is restricted to Visa and Mastercard credit cards issued by Axis Bank for secure tap-and-pay transactions.
- ❖ Compatible Apple device owners—including iPhone, iPad, and Apple Watch users—can make contactless NFC payments at in-store merchant terminals, apps, and online checkouts.
- ❖ Transactions processed via Apple Pay use tokenized card numbers and device-specific security codes, eliminating the need to share physical card numbers or enter OTPs for purchases.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **Axis Bank CEO:** Amitabh Chaudhry.
- ❖ **Apple Inc. CEO:** Tim Cook.
- ❖ **Axis Bank Headquarters:** Mumbai, Maharashtra, India.

2. Bank of India Introduces User-Level Programmable CBDC with Auto-Issuance Feature



- ❖ Bank of India has officially launched a user-level programmable Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) feature, enabling account holders to schedule automated issuances of the digital rupee (₹).
- ❖ Built on its CBDC platform developed by Montran India, the system allows users to set specific amounts, fixed frequencies, and designated beneficiaries for automated digital currency transfers.
- ❖ The programmable feature introduces purpose-bound utility, ensuring that funds transferred to a beneficiary's CBDC wallet are automatically restricted or utilized for intended transaction criteria.
- ❖ This automated distribution mechanism reduces manual intervention for recurring corporate or retail payouts while expanding the adoption of the Reserve Bank of India's digital currency.
- ❖ The digital rupee transactions operate securely within the RBI-backed CBDC infrastructure, maintaining legal tender status while providing programmable flexibility.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **Bank of India MD & CEO:** Rajneesh Karnatak
- ❖ **Bank of India Headquarters:** Mumbai, Maharashtra, India.
- ❖ **CBDC Regulator:** Issued and regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

Business and Economy

3. India's First Blue Financing in Maritime Sector: IFC Secures \$70M Deal with JNPA



- ❖ The International Finance Corporation (IFC) has partnered with Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) to provide \$70 million (~₹580 crore) in blue financing to establish Shore Power Supply (SPS) infrastructure across port terminals.

- ❖ This initiative marks India's first blue financing transaction dedicated to maritime infrastructure development, aligning with the country's broader goal of expanding sustainable green ports.
- ❖ Shore power technology allows docked ships to turn off their auxiliary diesel engines and plug directly into the terrestrial electrical grid, significantly curbing port emissions.
- ❖ The ₹650 crore project aims to lower carbon emissions by 63%, cut local air pollutants by up to 90%, and generate over 400 local jobs.
- ❖ By shifting berthing vessels to clean energy, the initiative advances the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, setting a baseline for decarbonization across major Indian ports.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **JNPA Location:** Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra, along the Arabian Sea.
- ❖ **IFC Headquarters:** Washington, D.C., United States (World Bank Group).
- ❖ **IFC Managing Director:** Makhtar Diop currently heads the International Finance Corporation.

National Affairs

4. Cabinet Approves Mega ₹2.79 Lakh Crore Package for Agriculture, Renewable Energy, and Urban Transport



- ❖ The Union Cabinet approved a financial package totaling ₹2,79,157 crore aimed at boosting farmer incomes, expanding green energy integration, and modernizing urban traffic management.
- ❖ A major allocation of ₹90,962 crore was designated for higher Minimum Support Prices (MSPs) across six Rabi crops to ensure

remunerative prices for farmers for the upcoming marketing season.

- ❖ The largest outlay of ₹1,86,405 crore was sanctioned for the Green Energy Corridor Phase III (PM DHARA) to construct power evacuation infrastructure for 135 GW of renewable capacity.
- ❖ An amount of ₹1,790 crore was approved for an AI-powered Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS) in Delhi to reduce congestion and enable automated violation detection across 1,092 signalized locations.
- ❖ C-DAC (Centre for Development of Advanced Computing) will serve as the Project Management Consultant for implementing and managing the multi-phase ITMS rollout.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **C-DAC Headquarters:** Pune, Maharashtra.
- ❖ **Ministry of Power:** Governs the Green Energy Corridor initiative.
- ❖ **Cabinet Secretariat:** Headed by the Cabinet Secretary of India.

International Affairs

5. US Launches 'FORTRESS America' Defence Security Infrastructure Initiative



- ❖ The US Department of War launched the FORTRESS America initiative (Federal Operations for Resilience, Troop Resources, Energy, Supply, and Survivability) to insulate defense infrastructure against hostile cyberattacks, sabotage, and geopolitical disruptions.
- ❖ The core objective of the framework is to make major domestic military installations completely independent of the civilian power grid to ensure uninterrupted operations during national emergencies.

- ❖ Built around five strategic pillars, the framework focuses on energy independence, supply-chain resilience, strategic defense reserves, cyber/installation hardening, and resilience in space and spectrum.
- ❖ The program mandates the domestic reshoring of critical military supply chains, including rare earth elements, specialty metals, semiconductors, and propellants.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **US Capital:** Washington, D.C. (located on Potomac River).
- ❖ **Pentagon Headquarters:** Arlington County, Virginia, United States.
- ❖ **Currency of US:** United States Dollar (\$) (Issued by Federal Reserve).

State Affairs

6. Jharkhand's Traditional Folk Drum 'Mandar' Awarded Geographical Indication Tag



- ❖ Mandar, a traditional percussion instrument of Jharkhand, has officially secured the Geographical Indication (GI) tag, providing legal protection and market identity to local tribal artisans.
- ❖ The application for the GI registration was submitted by Raidih Mandar Producer Company Limited based in Jarjatta village located in Jharkhand's Gumla district.
- ❖ Crafted from locally sourced red clay and animal hide, the barrel-shaped drum features asymmetrical ends and uses a specialized black tuning paste called Kiran for sound control.
- ❖ Played prominently during major tribal festivals like Sarhul and Karma, the instrument holds deep cultural significance for communities including the Santhal, Oraon, and Munda.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **GI Registry Location:** Headquartered in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.
- ❖ **GI Act Enactment:** Geographical Indications Act came into force in 1999.
- ❖ **Jharkhand Capital & Governor:** Capital is Ranchi; Governor is Santosh Kumar Gangwar.

Defence and Securities

7. Indian Army Conducts Exercise 'Jai Se Vijay' on NH-911 in Rajasthan



- ❖ The Indian Army successfully conducted **Exercise 'Jai Se Vijay'** on September 29, 2026, utilizing a designated stretch of National Highway-911 near Dantour in Rajasthan as a temporary military runway.
- ❖ Executed near the India-Pakistan international border, the strategic drill was spearheaded by the **Sapta Shakti Command** (South Western Command) to test rapid operational deployment capabilities.
- ❖ Army Aviation Corps platforms, including **Rudra, Dhruv, and Chetak helicopters**, executed precision daytime and simulated emergency landing and take-off drills on the highway surface.
- ❖ The exercise aimed to validate the capability of converting civilian national highways into emergency landing strips and tactical logistics hubs for military assets during conflict scenarios.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **Sapta Shakti Command Headquarters:** Located in Jaipur, Rajasthan.
- ❖ **Chief of the Army Staff:** General Upendra Dwivedi.
- ❖ **Rajasthan Capital & Governor:** Capital is Jaipur; Governor is Haribhau Bagade.

MoUs and Agreements

8. DRDO and CSIR-CGCRI Launch Joint Project for Indigenous Lightweight Bulletproof Glass



- ❖ The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and CSIR-Central Glass and Ceramic Research Institute (CSIR-CGCRI) have initiated a ₹50-crore project to develop advanced transparent armor.
- ❖ The four-year collaborative research aims to reduce the weight and thickness of bulletproof glass for military vehicles by up to fifty percent.
- ❖ Participating laboratories include the Naval Materials Research Laboratory in Maharashtra and the Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory in Chandigarh.
- ❖ The newly designed transparent ceramics are engineered to withstand direct high-velocity rifle and multi-shot ballistic impacts.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ DRDO Headquarters is located in New Delhi.
- ❖ CSIR-CGCRI is situated in Kolkata, West Bengal.
- ❖ Dr. Samir V. Kamat serves as DRDO Chairman.

Reports and Ranking

9. Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings 2027



- ❖ The University of Oxford secured the top position globally for an unprecedented 11th

consecutive year, followed closely by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in second place.

- ❖ US and UK institutions continued their dominant presence at the top, occupying all positions in the global top 10 list.
- ❖ Asian universities made historic strides, with China's Tsinghua University rising to 11th place and three Asian institutions entering the top 15 globally for the first time.
- ❖ Indian higher education saw representation led by the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru, which retained its spot as the top-ranked institution in the country.
- ❖ The 2027 edition evaluated 2,297 universities across 118 countries and territories using performance indicators spanning teaching, research environment, research quality, industry engagement, and international outlook.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **THE Head Office:** Based in London, United Kingdom.
- ❖ **IISc Established:** Founded in 1909 in Bengaluru, Karnataka.
- ❖ **Oxford University:** Oldest university in the English-speaking world.

Important Days

10. International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste



- ❖ The international community observed the seventh annual International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste on September 29, 2026, to accelerate global efforts against food waste.
- ❖ The official theme for the 2026 observance is "Transformative Potential of Reducing Food Loss and Waste," emphasizing sustainable resource management and food security.



- ❖ Global data reveals that approximately 13 percent of food is lost post-harvest before reaching retail, while 19 percent of consumer-available food goes to waste.
- ❖ The initiative supports Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) Target 12.3, which aims to halve per capita global food waste and reduce food supply chain losses by 2030.

Static GK Facts:

- ❖ **FAO Headquarters:** Rome, Italy.
- ❖ **UNEP Headquarters:** Nairobi, Kenya.
- ❖ **SDG Target Year:** Target year set for 2030.

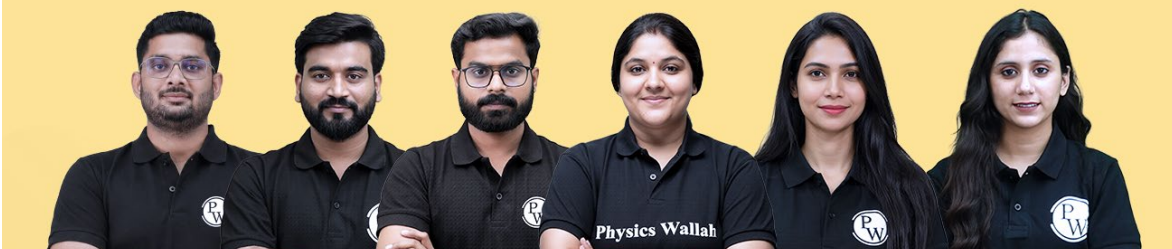


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